

REAL-WORLD SYNTHESIS

Participatory Design in Practice

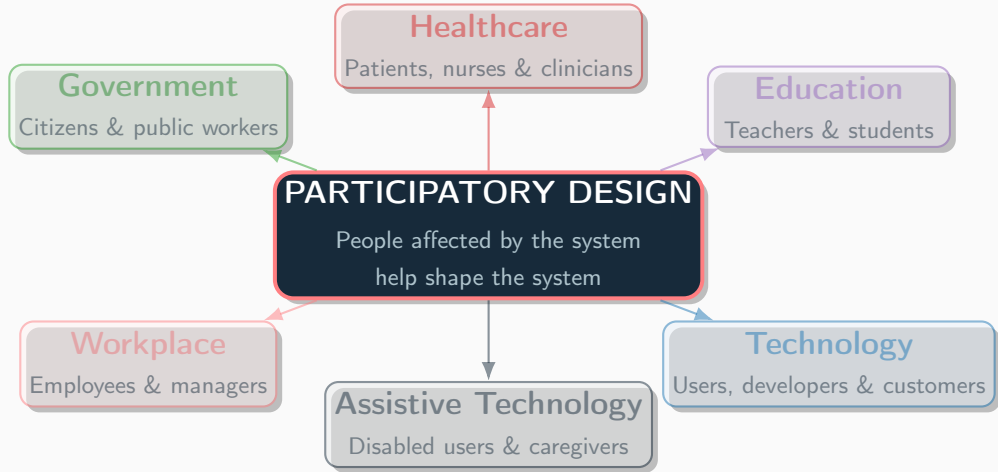




**Participatory Design matters because
it changes who gets to shape the system.**

Where does it work, what does it add, and where does participation become difficult?

Applications: Where Does PD Show Up?



Application Lens: Real Context Matters

HEALTHCARE

Users: patients, nurses, clinicians

Problem: clinical work involves time pressure and workarounds.

PD: observe workflows, prototype with users and refine around practice.

EDUCATION

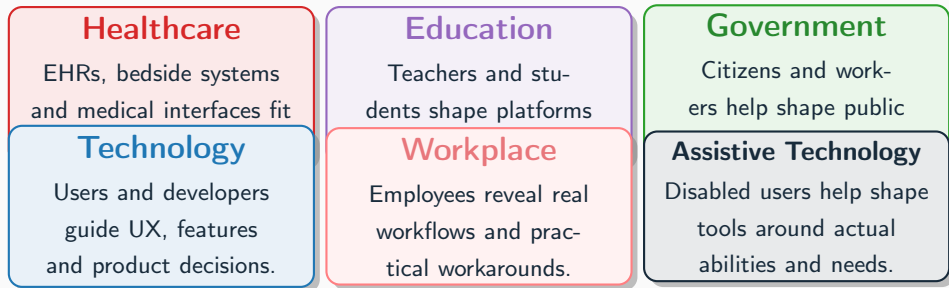
Users: teachers, students

Problem: a technically good platform may not fit classroom reality.

PD: co-design activities, learning flows and interaction patterns.

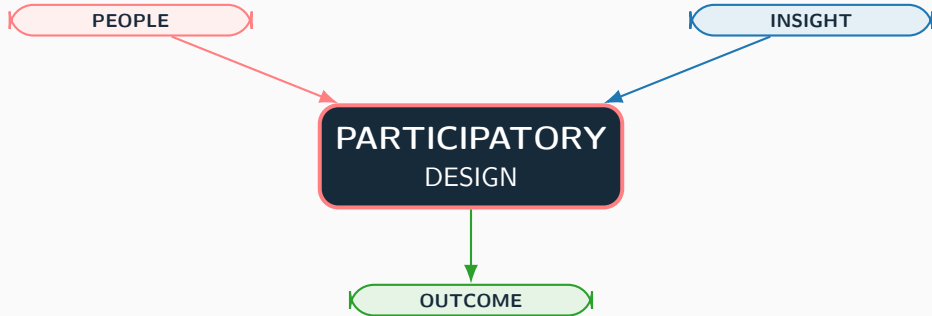
The value is not simply asking users what they want; it is learning how the system fits into real life.

Six Domains, One Principle



Different domains. Same idea: the people who live with the system should influence its design.

Benefits: Why Bring People Into the Process?



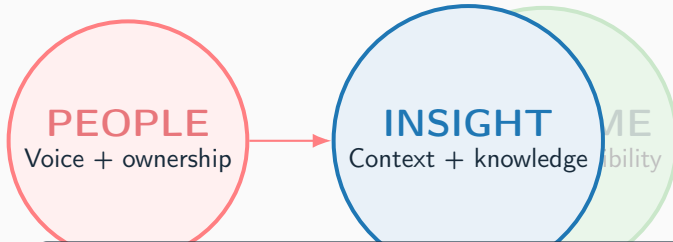
Three layers explain most of the value: **who participates**, **what they reveal**, and **what the design becomes**.

The Co-Creation Equation



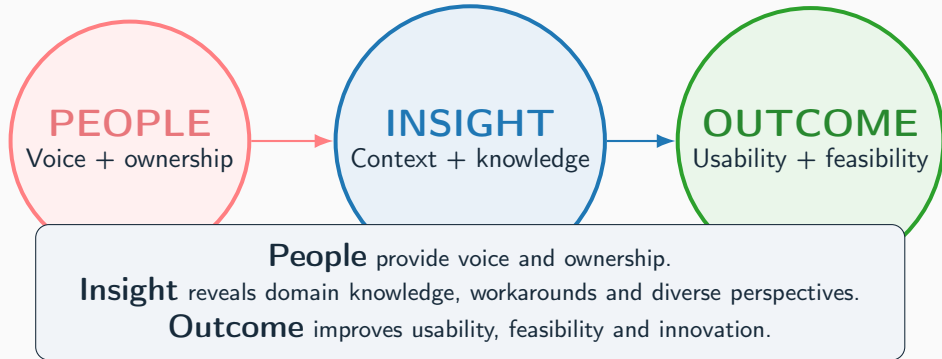
People provide voice and ownership.

The Co-Creation Equation

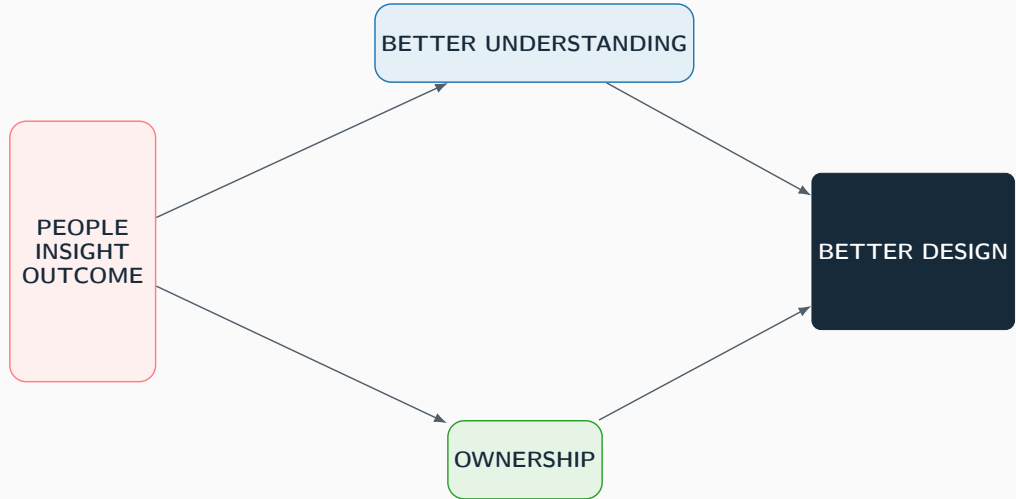


People provide voice and ownership.
Insight reveals domain knowledge, workarounds and diverse perspectives.

The Co-Creation Equation



Benefits: People → Insight → Outcome



Why Collaboration Is at the Heart of It



“Design is a process — an intimate collaboration between engineers, designers, and clients.”

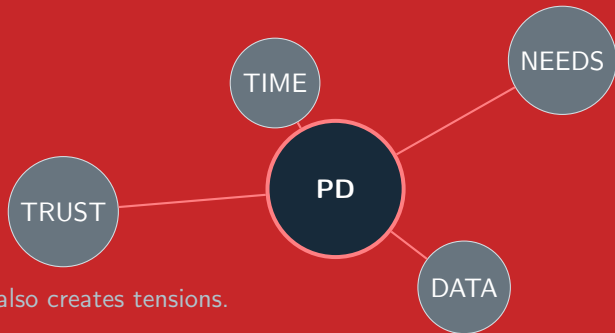
— Henry Dreyfuss, Designing for People, 1955

PD makes collaboration systematic:
people are not merely consulted — they participate in shaping the result.

Till now,

Sounds great.

So... what's the catch?



Participation creates value — but it also creates tensions.

Four Challenges to Manage

1. Conflicting Needs

Stakeholders want different outcomes and trade-offs.

2. Time & Logistics

Frontline users are busy; workshops require coordination.

3. Trust & Expectations

Users may fear token participation, while requests may exceed project scope.

4. Sensitive Information

Healthcare, government and enterprise work may involve private data.

The answer is not less participation — it is better-structured participation.

CONFLICT

Nurses may want speed.

IT may prioritize compliance.

Management may prioritize cost.

Response:

Negotiate trade-offs openly.

PD does not guarantee agreement. *It creates a space where disagreement can be made visible and negotiated.*

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TIME

Frontline users have little spare time.

Response:

Micro-sessions, targeted groups and asynchronous activities.

Time management is crucial.

Challenges: Conflict, Time, Trust and....

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TRUST

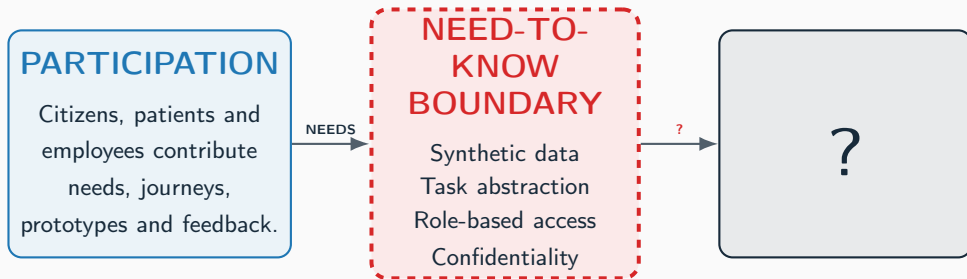
“Will they actually listen?”

Users may also expect every request to be implemented.

Response:
Be transparent and show impact.

Designers are to respect clients' expectations. *Stakeholders* must trust the skills of designers.

Challenge IV: Participation vs. Privacy

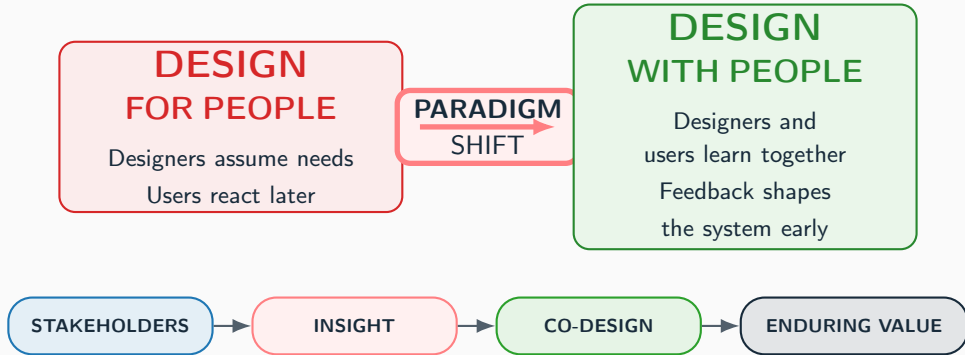


Key principle: participation does not mean everyone sees everything.



Participation can be broad in *purpose*
while access remains narrow in *scope*.

Conclusion: A Change in the Design Paradigm



THE CENTRAL TAKEAWAY

DESIGN FOR PEOPLE becomes DESIGN WITH PEOPLE

*"Participatory Design gives the people affected
by a system a meaningful voice in shaping it."*

THANK YOU

for listening
